



Note: AI 2 does not support Internet Explorer and instead recommends Chrome or Firefox.

Then, log in using your Google account to get started. You will have the IDE environment available shown in

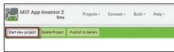


Figure 1: Start new project



Figure 2: The GreetMe app

TalkToMe project that is available in AI 2 tutorials.

Once you enter the name and press 'OK', you get the GUI where you can see its different elements explained, along with the numbers (Figure 3). For those of you who have worked with a GUI builder and an event handler based code execution environment, the App Inventor 2 offers the same features for Android app development.

In Figure 3, the following elements are numbered.

1. **Project name:** The name of the project is visible here.
2. **Designer/Blocks:** Here, the information on which view is active is shown. The button that is shown as pressed is actually the active view. In this case, the view is in 'designer' mode (more about the same in the next section).
3. **User Interface:** In the palette, all GUI visible components, i.e., those that are made visible on a screen in your app and are associated with some functionality, are present under User Interface.
4. **Screen name:** Your app can have multiple screens. The default screen, which is named *screen1*, is visible here.

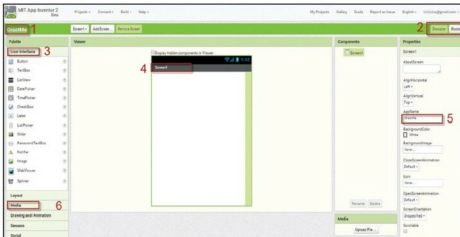


Figure 3: Project GUI elements explained



Figure 4: screen1 title and the GreetMe button



Figure 5: After adding screen 1 TextToSpeech and the clock

You can also see the same under the 'Components' tab (more on this later).

5. **App name:** By default, the 'App name' is the same as the project name that you have given. You can change the app name by changing this attribute under 'Properties'.
6. **Media:** Any Android app should have diverse and rich media capabilities. You will find widgets or components related to 'Media' under this section (more on this later).

The 'Designer view'

Basically, in the 'Designer view' you can select the GUI elements that should be visible on your screen. You can also determine the properties that could affect their display and their behaviour using the attributes available under 'Properties'. For our app, we will use a button which, when pressed, will do our bidding and help us code the required functionality. So let us insert a button and caption it 'GreetMe' as shown in Figure 4. To do this, drag the button from the palette on to *screen1* to create *button1*. Now click on the button, and change the text property to 'GreetMe'.

Also, to change the title of *screen1* to something more meaningful, let's select *screen1* and from *Properties->title*, set it to 'Time of the Day Greeter'. The end result should look like what's shown in Figure 4.

Also, in the 'Designer view' you can select other components that you want to use in your app, which might not show up in the screen. We require a couple of such items to complete our app. To start with, we need a way to greet that user when the button is pressed, and for this we will use the *TextToSpeech* component